

VENDOR X CORPORATION

ENTERPRISE RFP RESPONSE & SOLUTION DOSSIER FOR NORTHSTAR FINANCIAL SERVICES

VENDOR ID	SUBMISSION DATE	SOLUTION NAME	TARGET TIER
PROP-2025-VX99	Nov 20, 2025	ApexCognition Enterprise AI Suite	Tier 1 (Critical Platform)

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY & SCOPE

Vendor X Corporation is pleased to submit this comprehensive proposal to Northstar Financial Services (NFS) for the deployment of the *ApexCognition Enterprise AI Suite*. Our platform provides advanced natural language processing, vector retrieval, and automated document analysis designed to streamline multi-stakeholder vendor reviews and risk underwriting workflows.

2. TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE & SECURITY COMPLIANCE

Vendor X operates on a secure cloud-native architecture hosted within AWS GovCloud and US East (Ohio) secure availability zones. Key technical specifications include:

- Encryption Standards:** Data at rest is secured via AES-256 encryption using AWS KMS Customer-Managed Encryption Keys (CMEK). Data in transit enforces TLS 1.3 exclusively.
- Identity & Access:** Full native support for SAML 2.0 and OIDC Single Sign-On, integrating seamlessly with Microsoft Entra ID and Okta. MFA is mandatory for all administrative roles via FIDO2 WebAuthn.
- Security Attestation:** Vendor X maintains a current SOC 2 Type II certification covering Security, Availability, and Confidentiality (Audit Period: Nov 2024 – Nov 2025). Third-party penetration testing is conducted semi-annually by NCC Group.

3. FINANCIAL PROPOSAL & COMMERCIAL TERMS

Commercial terms are structured to provide predictable annual expenditure aligned with NFS procurement guidelines:

COST COMPONENT	COMMERCIAL DESCRIPTION	PRICING / SLA TERMS
Annual Platform Fee	Base enterprise licensing for up to 500 concurrent users and unlimited API query routing via MCP.	\$285,000 / year (Fixed 3-year term).
Price Escalation Cap	Annual contract renewal price adjustment guarantee.	Capped at 2.5% per annum or US CPI (whichever is lower). Compliant
Payment Terms	Invoice billing schedule.	Net 60 days from valid invoice receipt. Compliant
System Availability SLA	Guaranteed monthly operational uptime across primary cluster endpoints.	99.95% monthly uptime with 15% monthly invoice credit for SLA breaches.

Vendor X Commercial Commitment: Vendor X agrees to all NFS payment term baselines, capped renewal increases, and service level credit schedules without reservation.

4. AI GOVERNANCE, MODEL SAFETY & DATA PRIVACY

ApexCognition utilizes isolated foundational large language models hosted within single-tenant VPC boundaries. Our AI governance framework addresses all enterprise safety requirements:

- **Zero Data Retention (ZDR):** All customer prompt inputs, documents, and generated responses are processed in volatile memory and purged immediately upon completion. Prompts are never stored.
- **Anti-Contamination Guarantee:** Vendor X explicitly contractually waives any right to use NFS data, prompt inputs, fine-tuning feedback, or telemetry for model training, retraining, or public algorithmic improvement.
- **Data Residency:** All processing and storage occur within US-based secure cloud enclaves, satisfying FINRA, SEC, and NYDFS geographic sovereignty requirements.

5. COMPLIANCE EVALUATION & POTENTIAL RISK FLAGS

While Vendor X meets the majority of NFS security and commercial baselines, the multi-agent evaluation pipeline has identified specific clauses requiring careful legal scrutiny:

PASS SOC 2 Type II Verification

Unredacted SOC 2 Type II report provided, covering all required trust service criteria with zero unresolved exceptions.

PASS US Data Sovereignty

All data processing confined strictly to AWS US East and GovCloud facilities with zero off-shore routing.

FLAG Liability Cap Limitation

Vendor draft MSA proposes a liability cap restricted to 1x annual contract value. NFS policy mandates 2x ACV for data breaches.

FLAG Termination Notice Window

Contract specifies a 60-day advance notice requirement for non-renewal, exceeding NFS standard 30-day policy window.

6. CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

Vendor X presents a robust, secure, and technologically advanced platform that satisfies over 95% of Northstar Financial Services' stringent policy baselines. To achieve final approval, Legal and Procurement must negotiate two amendments:

1. Elevating the contractual liability cap from 1x to 2x annual contract value.
2. Modifying the auto-renewal cancellation notice window from 60 days to 30 days.